

Tata Steel Leave Policy

HR Department | 2024

Section 1: Policy Objective

This policy defines the types of leave available to employees, eligibility, accrual, and application procedures. The objective is to support employee wellbeing while ensuring operational continuity.

Section 2: Types of Leave

Casual Leave (CL):

- 12 days per year, credited 1 day per month
- Cannot carry forward
- Maximum 3 days at a time
- Cannot be combined with other leave types except with HR approval
- Approval from direct manager required, minimum 1 day advance notice (non-emergency)

Sick Leave (SL):

- 12 days per year, credited 1 day per month
- Medical certificate required beyond 3 consecutive days
- Can carry forward up to 15 days
- No encashment allowed
- Extended sick leave (beyond accrued balance) treated as Leave Without Pay unless medically certified for ESI benefit

Annual Leave / Earned Leave (AL/EL):

- 21 days per year, credited at 1.75 days per month
- Can carry forward up to 45 days
- Encashment allowed up to 30 days on retirement/resignation

- Minimum 3 days per application (except for single-day applications with prior approval)
- Must be planned and approved at least 7 days in advance for travel-related leave

****Maternity Leave:****

- 26 weeks for first two children
- 12 weeks for third child onwards
- Full pay during entire period
- Job security guaranteed on return — same or equivalent role
- Additional 8 weeks unpaid leave on request (Crèche facility provided at major locations)
- Work-from-home option for 1 month post return, subject to role suitability

****Paternity Leave:****

- 15 days within 6 months of child birth
- Full pay
- Non transferable
- Can be availed in maximum 2 splits

****Bereavement Leave:****

- 5 days on death of immediate family member (spouse, child, parent, sibling)
- Full pay
- No advance notice required

****Compensatory Off (Comp Off):****

- Granted for working on weekly off or company holiday
- Must be availed within 30 days of accrual
- Cannot be encashed

****Leave Without Pay (LWP):****

- Granted only when all other leave balances exhausted
- Requires HR and manager approval
- Affects continuity of service for benefit calculations beyond 30 days/year

Section 3: Leave Application Process

1. Apply on HR portal minimum 3 days in advance for planned leave
2. Emergency leave: Inform manager same day via call/SMS, regularize on portal within 2 days
3. Manager approves/rejects within 24 hours of application
4. HR system auto updates leave balance upon approval
5. Rejection must be communicated with reason via portal
6. Leave during notice period requires HR approval in addition to manager

Section 4: Leave Balance Tracking

- Check balance on HR portal anytime (real-time updated)
- Monthly statement emailed to all employees on 5th of every month
- Year-end summary circulated in March
- Lapse date for CL: 31st March every year (unused CL lapses)
- EL carry-forward cap: 45 days; excess automatically lapses unless encashed

Section 5: Holidays

- National Holidays: 3 days (Republic Day, Independence Day, Gandhi Jayanti) — fixed for all
- Festival Holidays: 7 days (employee chooses from a list of 12 regional/religious holidays published in January)
- Total Paid Holidays: 10 per year
- Holiday list published every January on HR Portal and notice boards
- Plant operations (continuous process) — holiday work compensated with Comp Off + holiday pay

Section 6: Special Leave Categories

Sabbatical Leave:

- Available to employees with 5+ years of service
- Maximum 6 months, unpaid
- For higher education, family care, or personal reasons
- Job guarantee on return subject to vacancy availability

Examination Leave:

- Up to 10 days per year for employees pursuing company-sponsored or relevant courses
- Requires proof of examination (admit card/hall ticket)

Marriage Leave:

- 5 days, once during service, for employee's own marriage
- Full pay

Section 7: Leave During Probation

- Probationary employees entitled to SL and CL on pro-rata basis
- EL accrual starts but cannot be availed until confirmation
- Maternity/Paternity leave applicable even during probation as per statutory requirement

Section 8: Leave Encashment Rules

| Leave Type | Encashable | When |

| --- | --- | --- |

| Casual Leave | No | - |

| Sick Leave | No | - |

| Earned Leave | Yes | On resignation/retirement, max 30 days |

| Comp Off | No | Must be availed |

Section 9: Frequently Raised Queries

- **Q: Can I take CL and SL together?** Generally not recommended; requires manager justification.
- **Q: What if I fall sick during approved EL?** Convert to SL with medical certificate, subject to SL balance.
- **Q: Is Sunday counted in leave days?** Weekly offs falling within a leave period are not counted as leave days for EL/CL, but are counted for LWP.